

A CAPABILITY FORMATION EXPERIENCE

Capability Position Read

Workbook

This workbook helps you read your current position. It does not tell you whether to stay or leave.

PRIVATE TO YOU · NOTHING IS SUBMITTED · KEEP BOTH READINGS

THE EVIDENCE WINDOW

Score everything against the last ninety days only — work that actually happened, not work that was approved, promised or planned.

THE RESPONSE SCALE

1 is strongly disagree. 5 is strongly agree. Whole numbers. On the second read you may mark a score with one question mark when the evidence cannot support it either way.

PRIVACY

Nothing in this workbook is submitted, collected or shared. No score, state, employer or identifying information is requested at any point. This workbook is yours.

KEEP BOTH READINGS

You will score the twelve statements twice. Do not erase or overwrite the first set. The distance between the two readings is the finding.

IN THE LIVE SESSION

Follow the presenter's pace. Every page shows the minutes it belongs to.

ON THE REPLAY

Pause and work at your own pace. Nothing here depends on keeping up.

FOUR PHASES, EIGHT PAGES

PHASE 1 PAGES 2-3

Initial Read

Twelve statements from memory, two totals, a first provisional placement.

PHASE 2 PAGE 4

Evidence Standard

What a corrected score has to survive, and what a question mark means.

PHASE 3 PAGES 5-7

Corrected Read

All twelve again with evidence, corrected totals, sensitivity, corrected position.

PHASE 4 PAGE 8

Next-Move Note

Three lines and a rescore date. The artifact you leave with.

Everything is available from the start. Nothing is released in stages.

PHASE 1 INITIAL READ

Live: minutes 5–9 · Replay: your own pace

INITIAL READ · DENSITY

Initial Density read

Statements 1 to 6. Score each one against the last ninety days. Write the number that is true, not the number you would prefer.

1 STRONGLY DISAGREE · 3 MIXED · 5 STRONGLY AGREE

1 In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve.

SCORE

1–5

2 I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think.

SCORE

1–5

3 My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly.

SCORE

1–5

4 The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel.

SCORE

1–5

5 I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it.

SCORE

1–5

6 Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then.

SCORE

1–5

INITIAL DENSITY TOTAL

 / 30

Adds up automatically in most readers — you can also type it in.

19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low
17 to 21 is a boundary on either axis

No evidence line yet — that is deliberate. You will come back to these twelve statements with evidence on pages 5 and 6.

PHASE 1 INITIAL READ

Live: minutes 9–14 · Replay: your own pace

INITIAL READ · OPTIONALITY

Initial Optionality read

Statements 7 to 12. Same scale, same ninety-day window.

1 STRONGLY DISAGREE · 3 MIXED · 5 STRONGLY AGREE

7 The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry.

SCORE

1–5

8 I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language.

SCORE

1–5

9 If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry.

SCORE

1–5

10 People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at.

SCORE

1–5

11 What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure.

SCORE

1–5

12 I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year.

SCORE

1–5

INITIAL OPTIONILITY TOTAL

 / 30

Adds up automatically in most readers — you can also type it in.

19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low
17 to 21 is a boundary on either axis

INITIAL POSITION Cross your two totals. Tick one. Hold it lightly.

☐

Compounding

☐

Depth Trap

☐

Stagnant

☐

Fragile

☐

Boundary

Rate your confidence in this placement from 1 to 5.

Private. You will rate it again on page 7 and compare.

Boundary is a legitimate reading. So is deciding, later, that an axis is incomplete.

PHASE 2 EVIDENCE STANDARD

Live: minutes 14–18 · Replay: your own pace

THE STANDARD

The evidence protocol

This is what your second reading has to survive.

Every corrected score requires an evidence line from the last ninety days.

Every score, in both directions.

A 4 OR 5	At least one clear positive instance from within the window.
A 3	The mixed or inconsistent pattern. A 3 is a reading, not an absence of one.
A 1 OR 2	What repeatedly happened instead, a counterexample, or no qualifying instance in the window.
A ?	Cannot support it either way? Write your most defensible number and add one question mark: 3?, 4?, 2?

WHAT THE QUESTION MARKS DO TO YOUR AXIS

NONE	No unsupported-item sensitivity range is required. Use the corrected total normally, subject to the standard boundary rule.
1 OR 2	That axis is PROVISIONAL. Run the neighbouring-score sensitivity check on page 7: total it as written, then again with every marked item one point lower, then one point higher.
3+	That axis is INCOMPLETE. Do not place yourself on it today. Incomplete is a legitimate reading, not a failure.

THE 17–21 BAND	An axis total of 19 to 30 reads high and 6 to 18 reads low. A total of 17 to 21 falls inside the boundary band, and the boundary reading OVERRIDES that split: no single state is assigned and you read both neighbouring states. The arithmetic does not change — only what the total entitles you to conclude.
ONE AXIS, OR BOTH	If exactly ONE axis is inside the band, read the two adjacent states that the OTHER axis selects. If BOTH axes are inside the band, record Boundary and assign no single state.

Every neighbouring score stays inside the 1 to 5 scale — a 1? is never tested at 0, a 5? is never tested at 6. This is an operational convention, not a statistical confidence interval, and it carries no margin of error.

An evidence line is a phrase, not an essay. One instance, one counterexample, or one honest “no qualifying instance in the window” is enough. Twelve statements in twelve minutes is sixty seconds each.

PHASE 3 CORRECTED READ

Live: minutes 18–30 · Replay: your own pace

EVIDENCE-BACKED READ · DENSITY

Evidence-backed Density read

Statements 1 to 6 again. New numbers with evidence behind them — not a review of your first set. Short phrases, not essays.

1 STRONGLY DISAGREE · 3 MIXED · 5 STRONGLY AGREE

1 In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve.

SCORE

1–5
with one ?
if unsupported

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

2 I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think.

SCORE

1–5
with one ?
if unsupported

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

3 My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly.

SCORE

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EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

4 The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel.

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EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

5 I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it.

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EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

6 Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then.

SCORE

1–5
with one ?
if unsupported

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

CORRECTED DENSITY TOTAL

 / 30

Adds up automatically in most readers — you can also type it in.

19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low
17 to 21 is a boundary on either axis

PHASE 3 CORRECTED READ

Live: minutes 18–30 · Replay: your own pace

EVIDENCE-BACKED READ · OPTIONALITY

Evidence-backed Optionality read

Statements 7 to 12 again. Evidence in both directions — a low score needs a counterexample as much as a high score needs an instance.

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SCORE

1–5
with one ?
if unsupported

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

8 I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language.

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9 If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry.

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10 People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at.

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11 What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure.

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EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

12 I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year.

SCORE

1–5
with one ?
if unsupported

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

CORRECTED OPTIONALITY TOTAL

 / 30

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19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low
17 to 21 is a boundary on either axis

PHASE 3 CORRECTED READ

Live: minutes 30–33 · Replay: your own pace

SECOND PLACEMENT

Your corrected position

Cross your two corrected totals. Then test whether the placement survives your question marks.

DENSITY / HIGH	☐ DEPTH TRAP Deep expertise fused to one context.	☐ COMPOUNDING Deep capability that travels. <i>The one square where both axes are high.</i>
	☐ STAGNANT The work stopped asking more of you.	☐ FRAGILE Options on paper, not enough depth beneath.
OPTIONALITY: LOW AT LEFT → HIGH AT RIGHT		

QUESTION-MARK STATUS

☐ No marked items
 ☐ 1–2 marked items → provisional
 ☐ 3+ marked items on an axis → incomplete

SENSITIVITY — RUN THIS ON ANY AXIS CARRYING ONE OR TWO MARKED ITEMS

	CORRECTED TOTAL	MARKED ITEMS ONE POINT LOWER	MARKED ITEMS ONE POINT HIGHER
DENSITY			
OPTIONALITY			

FINAL READING

☐ State
 ☐ Boundary
 ☐ Incomplete
 If a state, write it:

Rate your confidence in this placement from 1 to 5.

Compare it with the number you wrote on page 3. The comparison is private.

State is not identity.

It reads conditions in a ninety-day window, and it moves.

NOTES

PHASE 4 NEXT-MOVE NOTE

Live: minutes 42–46 · Replay: your own pace

THE ARTIFACT

The Next-Move Note

Three lines. Yours, private, and enough to act on.

MY CURRENT READ

My position appears to be:

State / boundary / incomplete

WHAT I NEED TO TEST

The category of move my evidence supports testing is:

One of the seven categories below.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

One action, conversation, or piece of evidence I will pursue next is:

One thing. Something you could begin this month.

Two signals I will watch before my rescore date:

and

THE SEVEN CATEGORIES OF MOVE

Direction, not a plan.

1 Remain and deepen

The formation conditions are real and worth protecting.

2 Translate what is built

The capability exists. The language for it does not.

3 Widen exposure

The work is good and the wrong people have seen it.

4 Test portability

Find out what travels before you need it to.

5 Repair the conditions

Change the work, not the employer, first.

6 Prepare for exit

Your evidence gives you reason to prepare in case the conditions do not repair.

7 Seek an outside perspective

High stakes, incomplete evidence, or a boundary position.

*No square prescribes a category. Your evidence and constraints still apply.***This is a note, not a decision.***It records what your evidence supports testing next.***My rescore date:***Ninety days out. Notice what changed.*

NOTES